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Public Speaking

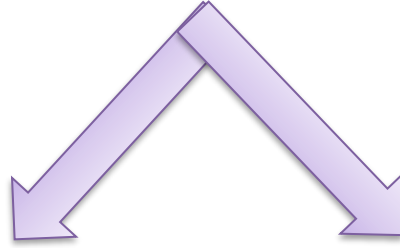
Lecture 48: Oral Presentation Part II

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Oral Presentation: Basic requirements



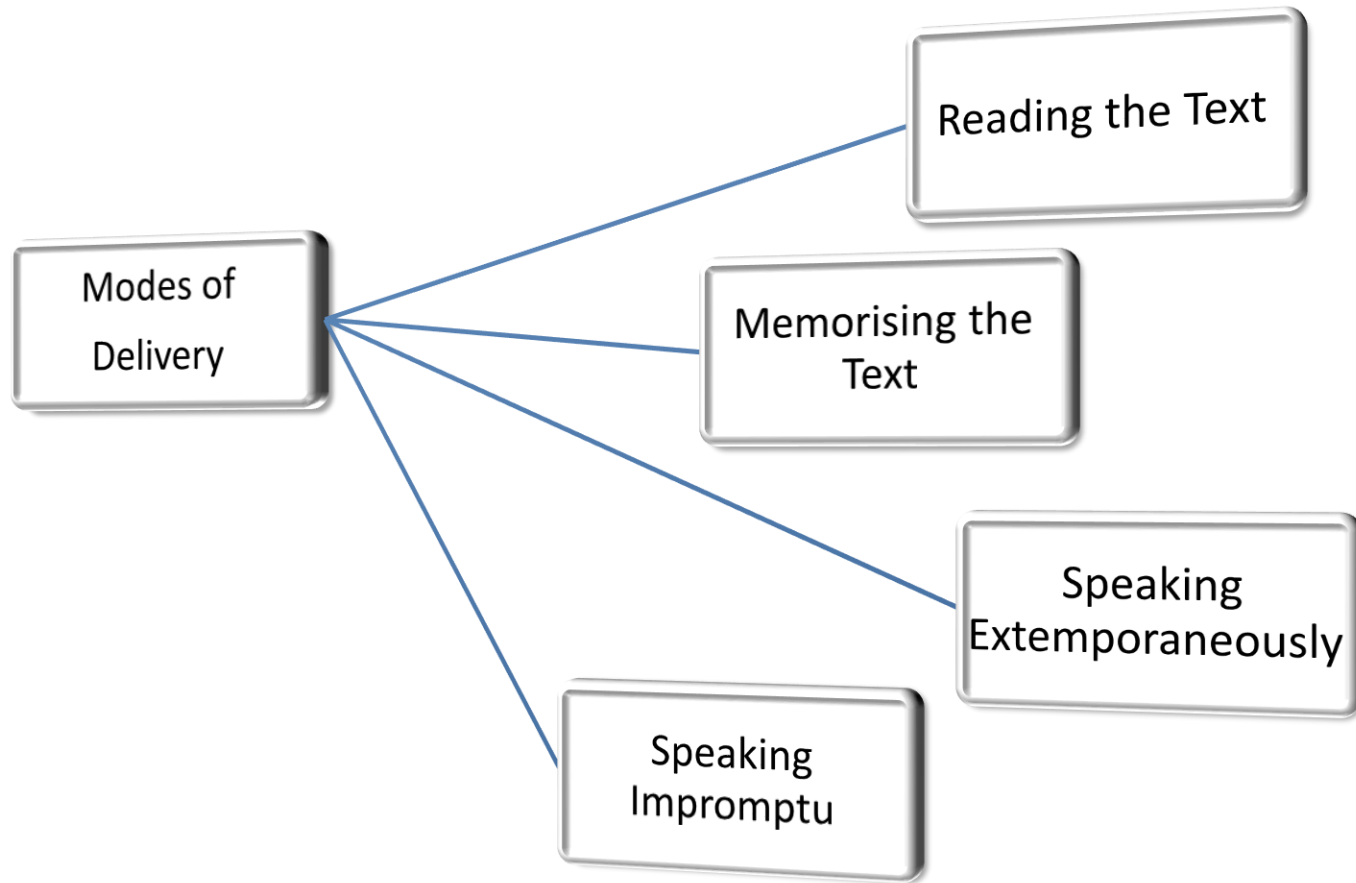
Speak with a vibrant voice, animated gestures and pleasant facial expression.

Mix judiciously the elements of an informal conversation as well as formal conversation.

(Mohan and Banerji 57)

Use of Voice

- ❖ Pleasant tone and adequate volume
- ❖ Neither too rapid nor tardy
- ❖ Rate and pitch variation
- ❖ Transitions to signal the end of presentations



Reading from the Text

- ❑ This mode of delivery is used in extremely formal situations.
 - ❑ Stick to the given time limit.
 - ❑ Use of appropriate-to-the-occasion phraseology
 - ❑ Pauses are to be used effectively and prior rehearsal is essential.
- ❖ Example: Speeches by President, Prime Minister, etc.



Advantages of Reading from the Text

- ✓ Several readings and revisions before the presentation help in getting used to the content and articulation of the delivery.
- ✓ Such a mode instils confidence in the presenter.
- ✓ The written text can be used for future references.
- ✓ The presentation hinges on the confluence of oral and written communication, therefore, meeting larger goals.
- ✓ There is little or no room for modification and one can simply stick to the text before him.

Memorizing the Text

- In this mode of delivery as well, the entire speech is written.
- It is prepared beforehand, so there is more room for confidence.
- Memorizing and delivery can be, however, an uphill battle.
- There are more disadvantages to this mode of delivery.



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Disadvantages of Memorizing the Texts

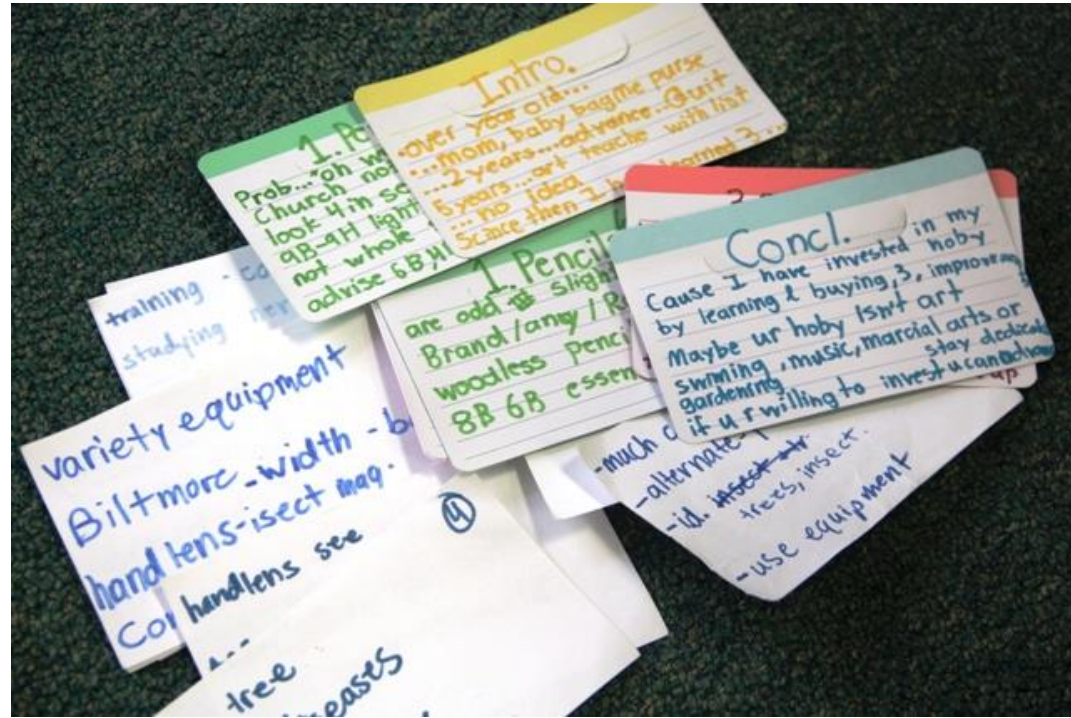
- It is a tedious and next to impossible task to memorize lengthy speeches.
- The presentation mostly lacks spark as the presenter might be occupied in recalling the points being spoken.
- There is no involvement of the audience directly so the presentation would be unable to serve its primary function.
- A memorized speech is likely to lose its vitality if not delivered with zeal and ease and in a way that would reflect that the presentation is not memorized but effortless.

Speaking Extemporaneously

- ❖ This mode of delivery is considered as the most effective mode.
- ❖ During the preparation of such presentation, one has to decide the quantity of matter to be used, followed by logical structuring.
- ❖ An outline has to be prepared on note cards for every point intended to be discussed.
- ❖ It provides a semantic structure to the entire presentation.
- ❖ It should not be mixed with other modes of delivery (some presenters write the script for the entire presentation and then make note cards but it is not advisable).

Note Cards should include:

- Keywords, phrases
- Points to be emphasized and elaborated
- Audio-visual aids, quotes, story, and fact to be carefully carved



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Advantages of Speaking Extemporaneously

- ❖ The presentation arrests the attention of the audience as the ideas are direct, agile and freshly placed.
- ❖ There is room for spontaneous ideas (desirable digressions as discussed in previous weeks).
- ❖ Ideas can be put across without linguistic constraints (one idea can be explored with multiple examples).
- ❖ This mode of delivery accommodates all the non-verbal communication tools.
- ❖ With the help of charts and graphs, a lot can be conveyed without any hassle and limitation of text on a page or in one's mind.

Speaking Impromptu

- As the name suggests, in this mode of delivery there is no prior preparation, one is just called randomly to deliver a talk or make a presentation.
- One should not panic on such occasions but be confident.
- To begin with, one can summarize the previous speeches or happenings during the ongoing event and then in due course can settle themselves in front of the mic and continue from there onwards.
- Being agile and convincing is the key to excel in this mode of delivery.

Time Management

- Time is an essential instrument of communication.
- One has to be very particular while managing time before during and after any presentation.
- While preparing content, allot time to every subtopic and have some buffer time as well.
- Use the given time well.



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Joint Presentation

- Co-ordination is the key during these presentations.
- The subtopics should be divided distinctly in order to avoid any commotion. However, both the presenters should be aware of each other's contents so they could have each other's back.
- Nobody should intend to outshine the other, only the presentation should outshine.



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Handling Questions

- ❑ Questions have the capacity to create confusion, chaos, and explore the central as well as the marginal ideas of the presentation.
- ❑ All the questions need to be addressed by the presenter.
- ❑ Questions can be of two kinds:
 - Direct Questions
 - Indirect Questions



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Contd...

- ✓ One should first **listen patiently** to the question and understand the requirements of the question.
- ✓ If the question is unclear, ask the concerned person to rephrase the question. Do not answer for the sake of answering.
- ✓ Answer should be brief and to the point and addressed to the general audience and not a targeted person.
- ✓ One cannot be a know-it-all. Admit if the answer is unknown or ambiguous.
- ✓ Distinguish relevant questions from irrelevant ones and answer smartly without offending anyone.

Meeting Unexpected Situations

Confidence comes hand-in-hand with preparation. If one has prepared well, one should be fearless, hopeful and optimistic.

Situation A

Unsupportive Audience: It may happen that the audience is resenting the presentation by grinning, acting distracted, and so on and so forth.

Solution:

Do not retaliate. Try to keep calm and look for common ground by asking questions and engaging with the audience and appreciating their contributions.

Contd...

Situation B

Forgetting the beginning of the presentation: It may happen to anyone in a different and unfamiliar space.

Solution:

Putting oneself at ease is extremely essential in such situations. Try to begin otherwise- ask and interact with the audience until you calm your nerves and begin from wherever you remember about your topic. Just keep in mind the time that was dedicated to that segment of the presentation. Do not digress completely.

Avoid Backtracking

- ❖ It is humane to forget or miss out on some points during the course of the presentation.
- ❖ One has to assess the significance of the point and whether it is absolutely important to include in the presentation.
- ❖ Revisiting any left-out point may tamper with the flow of the presentation so one should be absolutely sure before revisiting.
- ❖ Prepare well with note cards to make sure to avoid backtracking.

Making your Presentation Memorable

- ❖ A speaker is different from a writer.
- ❖ Everyone remembers what one sees better than what one hears or reads.
- ❖ Short-term memory stores individual words and phrases but long term memory remembers ideas and facts.
- ❖ Choose a few key points and re-inforce them to enable long term memory.

Points to Remember

- ✓ Be unaffected and unassuming.
- ✓ Be confident , businesslike, and sincere.
- ✓ Be optimistic, pleasant and cheerful.
- ✓ Be natural in posture and gestures.
- ✓ Be poised and at ease.
- ✓ Be enthusiastic and interested.

(Leland Brown)

Beginning and Closing your Presentation

- ✓ Begin with a quote/question/anecdote.
- ✓ Present your first sentence from memory.
- ✓ Maintain eye contact.
- ✓ Control voice and vocabulary.
- ✓ Continue signposting.
- ✓ Make natural movements.
- ✓ Use visual aids and avoid digressions.
- ✓ Summarize your main points with a clear statement.

*"If you don't know what you want to achieve in your presentation your audience never will."
- Harvey Diamond.*

Thank You

Work Consulted

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